problems of the telecom business. He also consolidated the acquisitions made by Ratan. Sensing the uninspiring steel market in Europe, he moved to give Tata Steel an India focus.

Chandrasekaran worked to restore the faith of investors and senior leadership and lay the growth path for the next decade. During his first five years as chairman, 'the Tata Group's total market cap rose by 176 % or just short of a threefold rise. Of the 23 listed Tata firms, the market value of 15 more than doubled during the period.' Through these steps, Chandrasekaran, in his first five years, achieved continuity in policies while calibrating them to face future challenges. It pitched him to be the best talent to lead the group and make it future ready.

Harvesting Success

The innovative programmes he introduced and his success in steering the conglomerate during a difficult period earned Chandrasekaran another five years at the helm on 11 February 2022. The Tata Sons press release, issued on the same day, said that Ratan 'who was a special invitee to the meeting, expressed his satisfaction with the progress and performance of the Tata Group under the leadership of Mr N Chandrasekaran' and recommended his 'term be renewed for a further five-year period.'

Speaking about the second term, Ratan says that it was not only Chandrasekaran's performance in the last five years that influenced his decision, but also his record in steering TCS when he was the chairman of the latter. Ratan feels that Chandrasekaran's strongest attribute is his 'understanding of newer technologies', which the operating companies of the group 'have to embrace'. His leadership of the group was recognized globally in 2022, when the fifty-nine-year-old businessman and Padma Bhushan awardee was ranked among the top twenty-five CEOs in the world by Brand Finance, the world's leading brand valuation consultancy.

Chandrasekaran's appointment restored dignity, growth, and energy rekindling innovativeness in the group. Both Mistry's replacement and this were momentous events for the group and particularly for Ratan. The former marked the beginning of the most tumultuous phase in the history of the group and a period of extreme stress and anxiety for Ratan. The latter brought about a phase of stability and silent growth for the group and quietude for Ratan.